

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 58

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Ernest Hamilton "Buddy" Parks of Chattanooga.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Ernest Hamilton "Buddy" Parks of Chattanooga; and

WHEREAS, Ernest Hamilton Parks was an exemplary gentleman and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in 1932 to a Chattanooga family of storied and successful contractors, Mr. Parks graduated from Central High School and then the University of Chattanooga, where he earned a bachelor's degree in engineering physics and a commission as a second lieutenant in the United States Army; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Parks, having married his beloved wife, Mackie Sue Roberts, and desiring to serve his country, moved to Oklahoma to act as an instructor at Fort Sill; and

WHEREAS, he went on to work at Combustion Engineering, and after his retirement in the 1980s, he began to manage some of the properties of former U.S. Senator Bob Corker, including such distinguished Chattanooga structures as the James Building and the Volunteer Building; and

WHEREAS, the rejuvenating influence of Mr. Parks's management also extended to the famous Dome Building and nearby Customs House, both of which have merited recognition on the National Register of Historic Places; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Parks did not content himself with overseeing the affairs of this world but also busied himself with caring for the souls at Hixson Church of Christ; and

WHEREAS, raised a Baptist, Mr. Parks became a member of the Churches of Christ a year after his marriage, and he went on to serve at both East Ridge Church of Christ, where he was a deacon, and Hixson Church of Christ, where he was an elder for twenty-five years; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Parks deftly applied his skill base from building management to help redesign one of the church's buildings into a gym and multipurpose area while also constructing a new worship space; and

WHEREAS, even in the midst of little help and heavy burdens, Mr. Parks and his fellow elder Pat Roark dedicated themselves to visiting and comforting some 350 congregants, meeting and discussing weekly about how best to serve their community; and

WHEREAS, passionately appreciative of boats, Mr. Parks and his wife enjoyed nautical outings in their spare time, and when his wife's health prevented their further boating, Mr. Parks once again exhibited his characteristic versatility and creativity by fashioning over twenty wooden model boats, most being replicas of historic watercraft; and

WHEREAS, the Morning Pointe Senior Living home, where Mr. and Mrs. Parks spent their last years together, allowed Mr. Parks to convert a storage space adjacent to his apartment into a workshop for his model making, and after constructing so many as to need extra space, the property company agreed to allow Mr. Parks, who had worked with the company for fifteen years, to put up shelves and glass cases to display his handiwork; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Parks was also deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, a loving father, grandfather, and great-grandfather, he is survived by his son, Ted Parks; daughter, Susan (Philip) Tuckniss; grandchildren, Andrew (Heather) Rogers, Aden St. Charles, Benjamin (Emily) Parks, and Jacob Parks; and five great-grandchildren, Jackson Rogers, Ella Rogers, Hadley Rogers, Pax St. Charles, and Mabry St. Charles; and

WHEREAS, he was preceded in death by his wife, Mackie Sue Roberts Parks; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Parks leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Ernest Hamilton "Buddy" Parks, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Parks.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.